What is BC Hydro Sustainment project?

BC Hydro has ongoing projects required to maintain and upgrade existing electricity infrastructure such as aging equipment, improving transmission and substation systems, maintenance works to meet the energy needs of BC.

An example is the Peace to Kelly Lake Stations Sustainment Project - this project is required to maintain the reliability of BC Hydro's bulk transmission system by replacing station assets within the Peace to Kelly Lake transmission system that are at end-of-life.

What does "Energy Purchase Agreement from BC Hydro" mean?

Since 2024, BC Hydro has issued a call for power from clean or renewable resources and awarded Electricity Purchase Agreements to successful proponents. Clean Energy Projects include projects focused on producing energy from wind, water, solar, tidal or biomass power.

You can find more information here: https://www2.gov.bc.ca/gov/content/industry/natural-resource-use/natural-resource-permits/permit-connect-bc#electrification

What is Permit Connect?

The B.C. government is streamlining and simplifying the way permits are issued by the provincial government. It is coordinating the permit process based on priority initiatives.

The Permit Connect Navigator Service (PCNS) is a portal for registering your housing or electrification project. Through this service, you can talk to a navigator who will help to coordinate the permitting process and identify which natural resource provincial permits you will need.

You can find more information here: https://www2.gov.bc.ca/gov/content/industry/natural-resource-use/natural-resource-permits/permit-connect-bc

Am I required to register my project at Permit Connect?

This service delivers specialized client support by assisting applicants throughout the permitting process and clarifying which natural resource permits are required for their project. Hence, it is recommended that you register your project with the service.

If you haven't registered your project yet, please do so here: https://www2.gov.bc.ca/gov/content?id=1EC15026BB3D4CDAB0109D2720BDDCF2

You can find the project ID once you have registered your project.

Major Mine in British Columbia

To find more information about the major mines in British Columbia use this link: https://mines.nrs.gov.bc.ca/mines

Where can I find the Mines Act Permit Number?

A **Mines Act Permit Number** is a unique identifier assigned by the Chief Inspector of Mines or Chief Permitting Officer to an authorized mining, exploration, or quarry site. These numbers typically feature alphanumeric formats like prefix letters followed by digits (e.g., G- for gravel/sand, MX- for mineral exploration, or Q- for quarries) linked to a specific mine file number.

You can find more information here: https://www2.gov.bc.ca/gov/content/industry/mineral-exploration-mining/permitting/mine-exploration

If my application relates to one of the categories like BC hydro, films, housing supply or major mines, does it speed up the timeline?

The application still goes through the same stages of review regardless of the associated categories and the timeline is at least a few weeks from the data of submission. Adding as much available information as possible in a clear fashion may help reduce the clarifications needed by the reviewers.